

Progettazione di Applicazioni Mobili

Mobile design patterns

Tools

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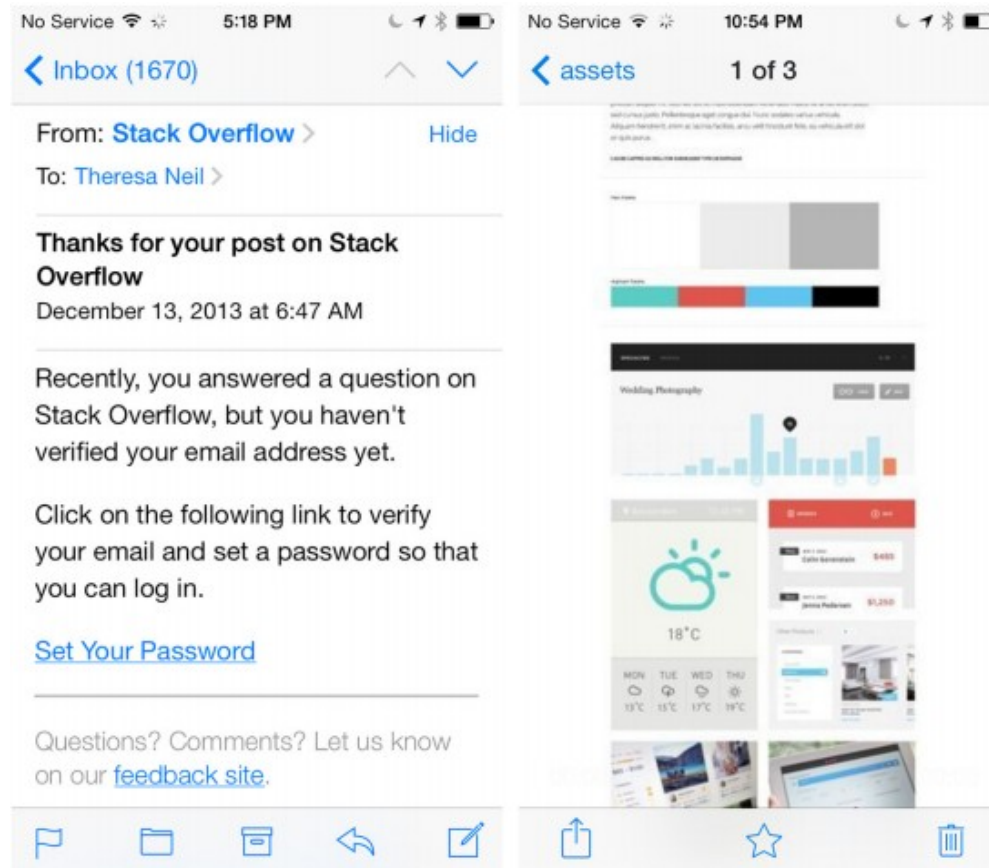
Tools

- Tools patterns include all those solutions that allow users to perform actions on the content of a specific screen of an application
- Despite possible similarities in terms of visual design, tools patterns should not be confused with navigation patterns

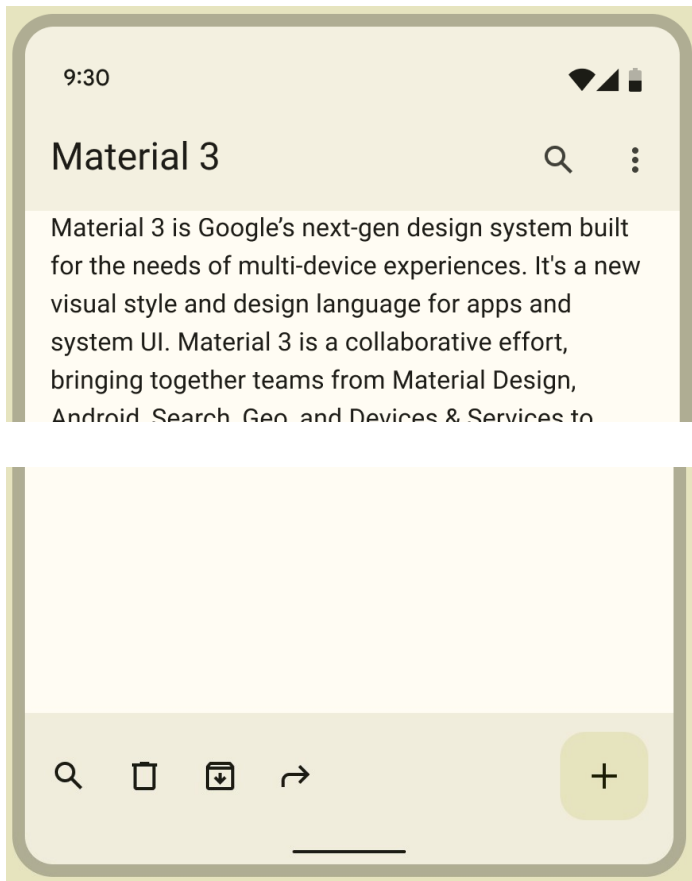
Toolbar

- The Toolbar is one of the most common ways to provide screen specific actions
- A toolbar gives users controls, typically displayed as icons, that act on the contents of the current screen
 - A toolbar doesn't enable navigation
- Each operating system has its own terminology and guidelines for the Toolbar
 - Follow OS-specific recommendations for Toolbar placement and behaviors
 - Choose icons that are familiar and easy to recognize

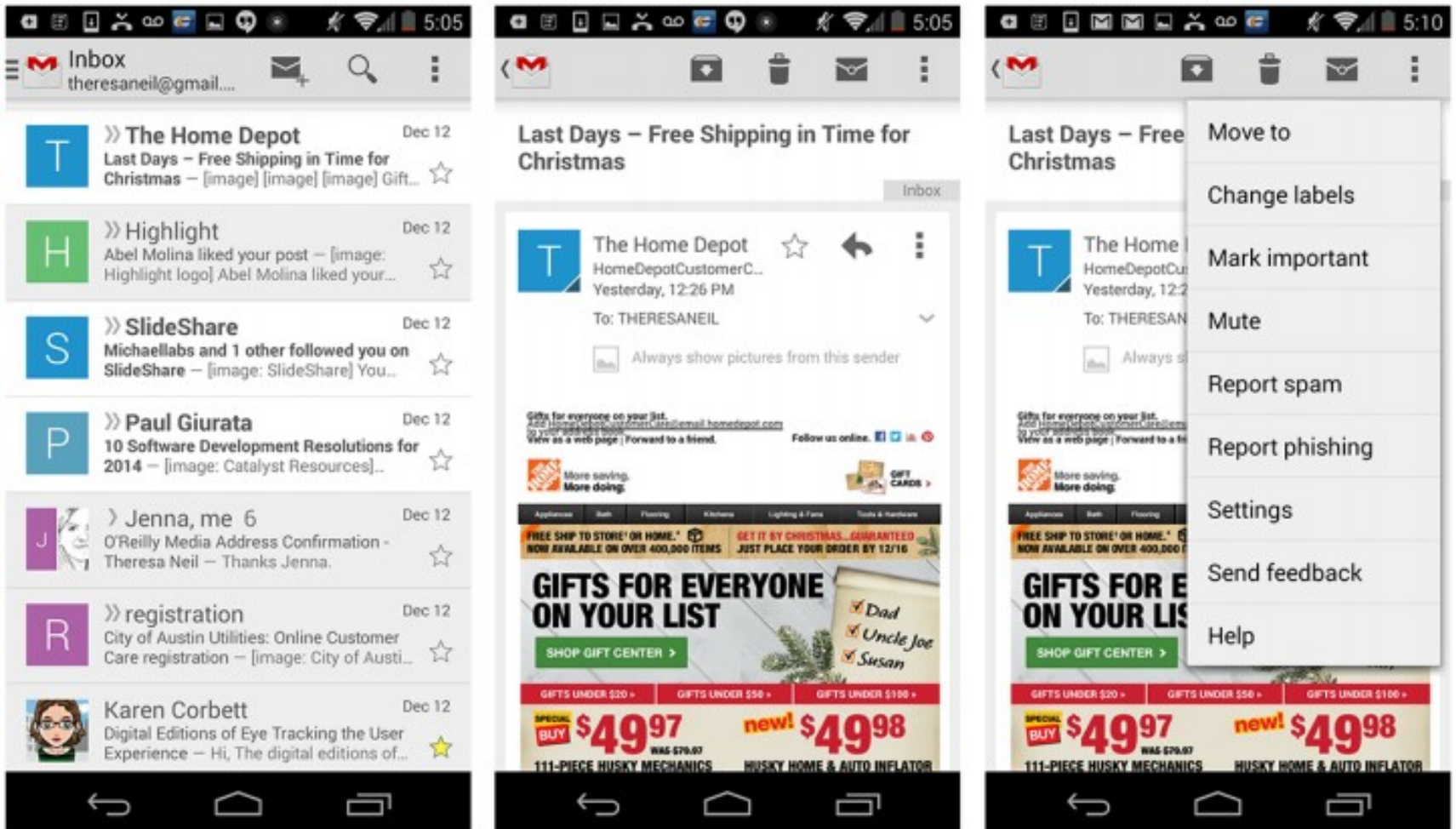
- In iOS a toolbar typically appears at the bottom edge of a screen or view



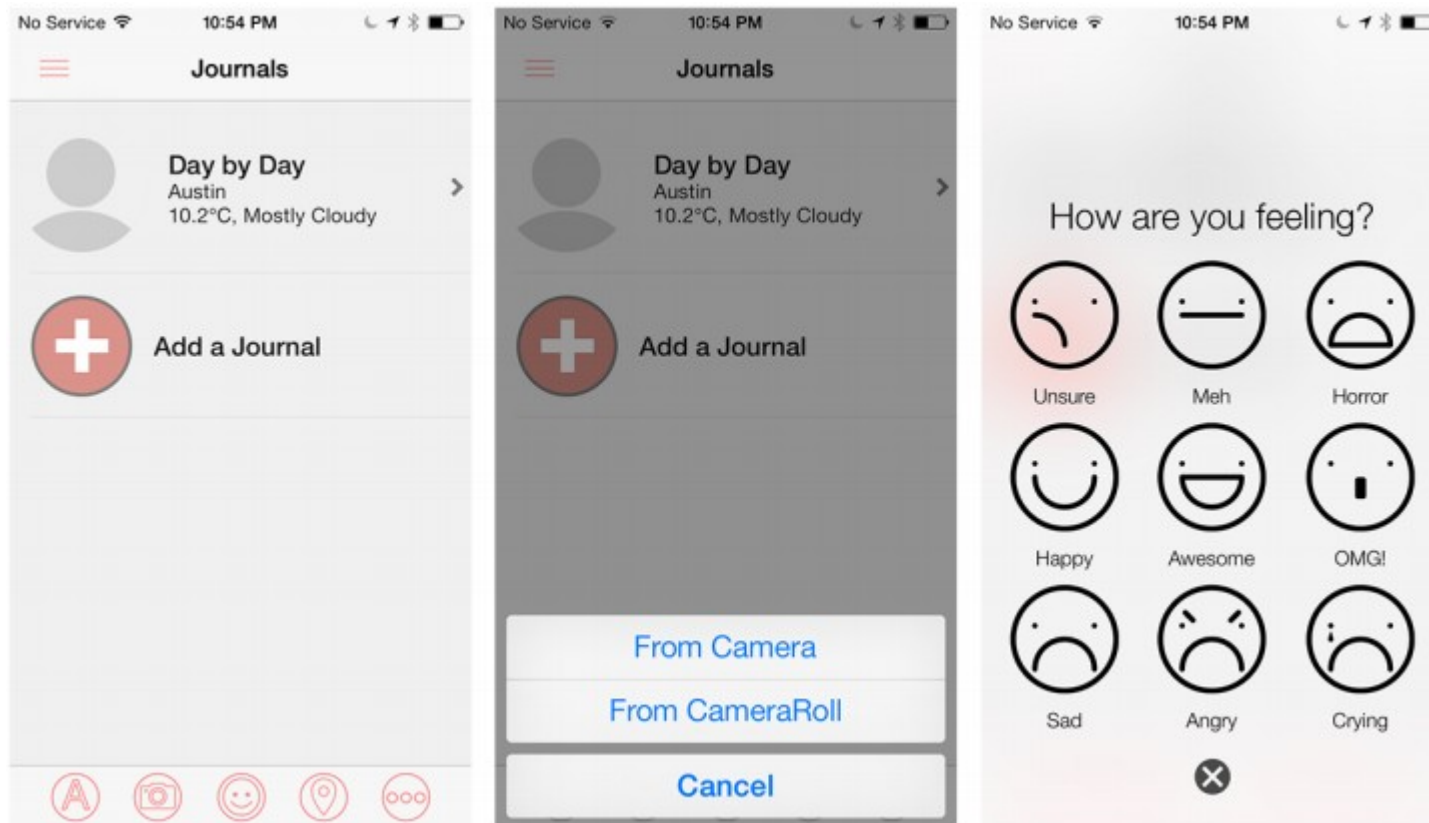
- In Android, action buttons can be displayed at the top right of the main App Bar, as a contextual action bar, or in the bottom app bar



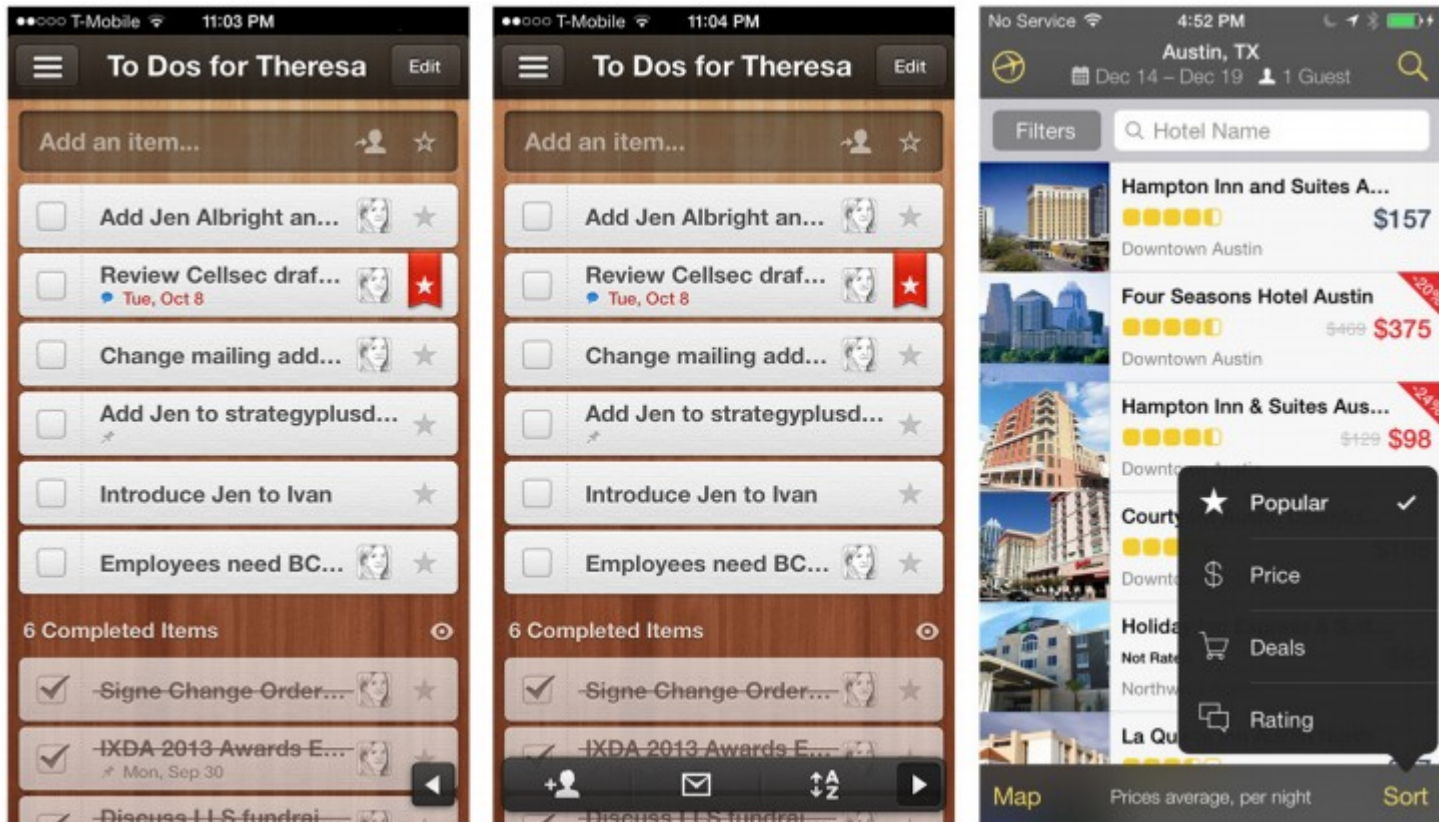
- Toolbar buttons may depend on screen context



- Toolbar buttons may launch Action Sheets / Bottom Sheets that display choices associated to the selected action



- Custom toolbars with cascading or collapsing behavior can be found in some apps



Toolbox

- A Toolbox is like a Toolbar on steroids
- You'll see this pattern most often in photography and design apps that offer a lot of tools for effects and treatments
- Typically, the main Toolbox is positioned across the bottom of the screen
- Various designs are possible to manage the visualization of a high number of Toolbox options, including scrolling

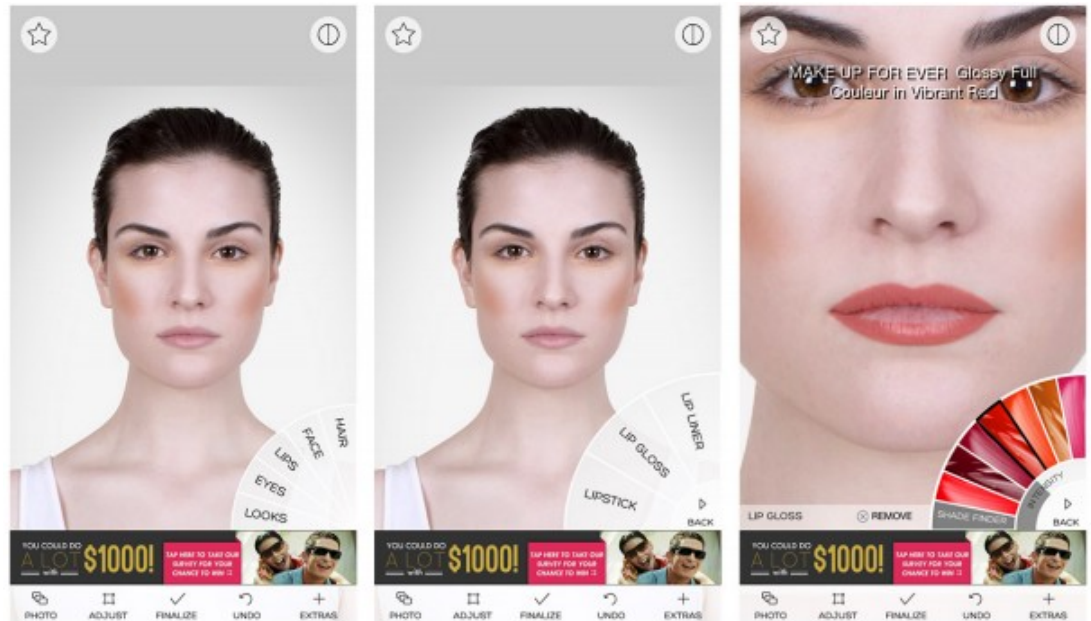
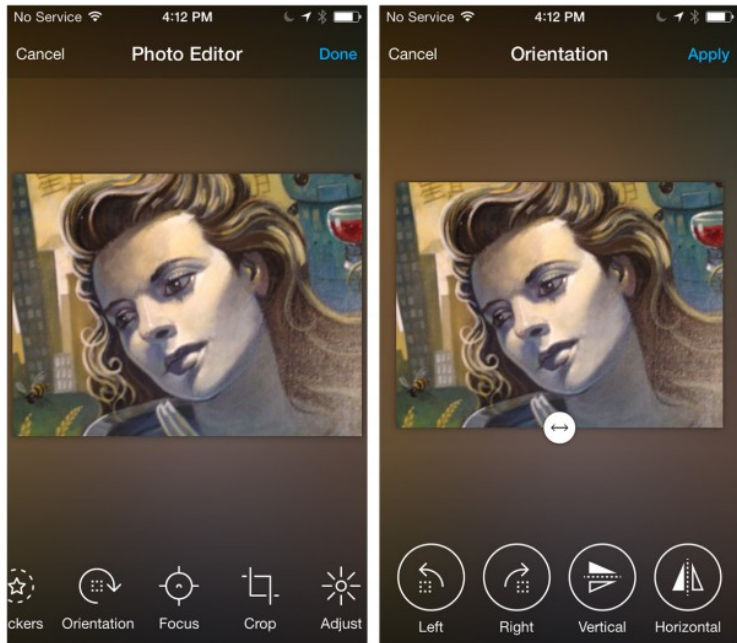
- Selecting an option from the main Toolbox can reveal an overlay menu of options specific to the selected tool



- Tool options may appear as a second row above the Toolbox

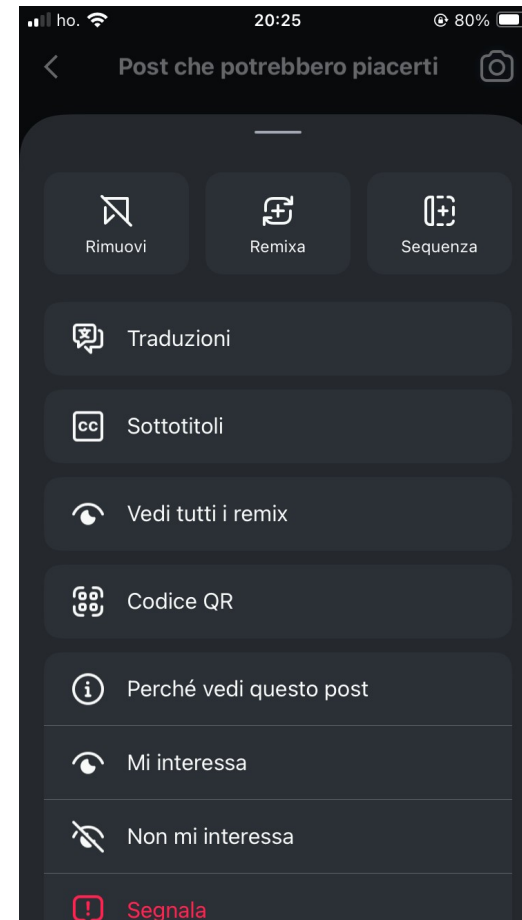
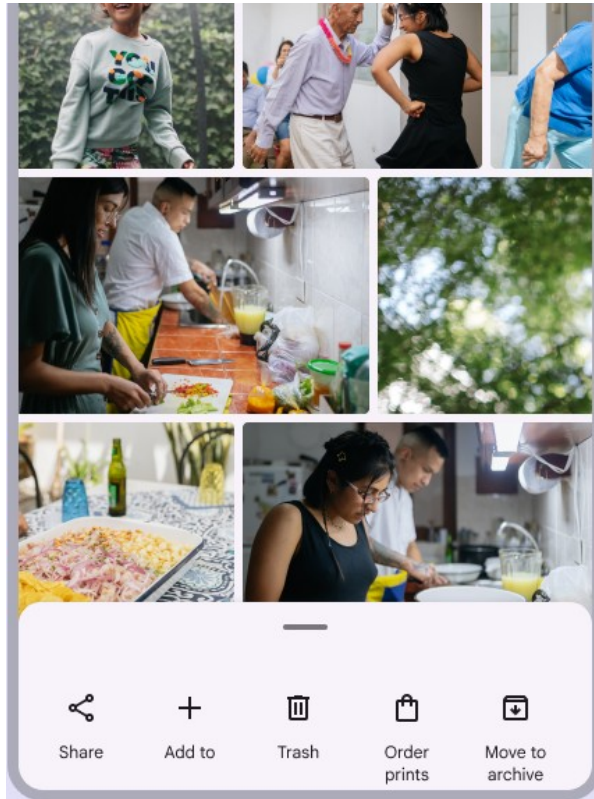


- If tool options hide the main Toolbox, let users know where they are and include a Cancel button



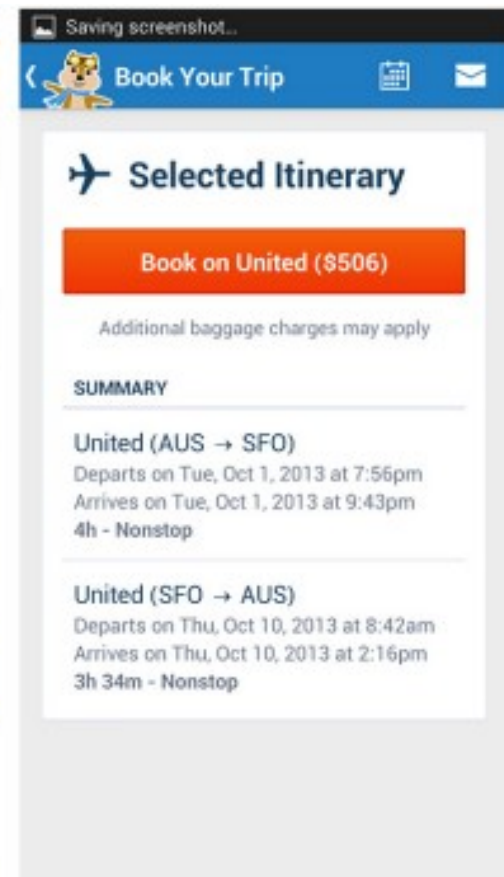
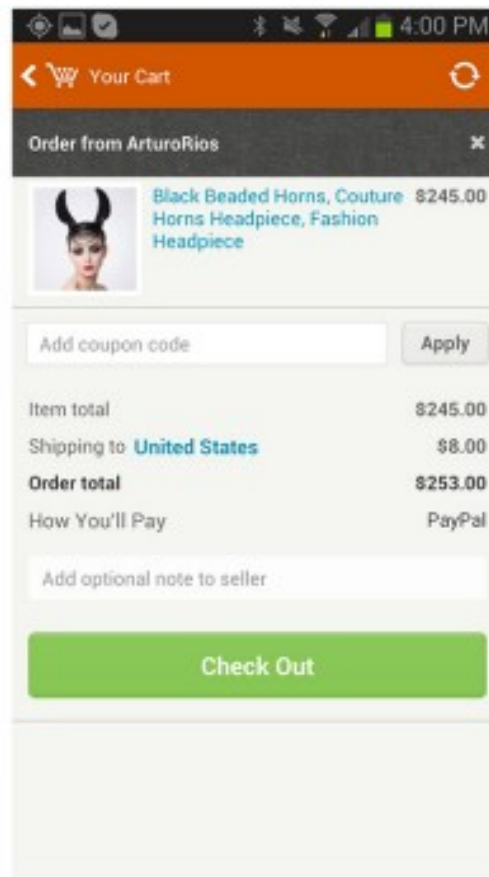
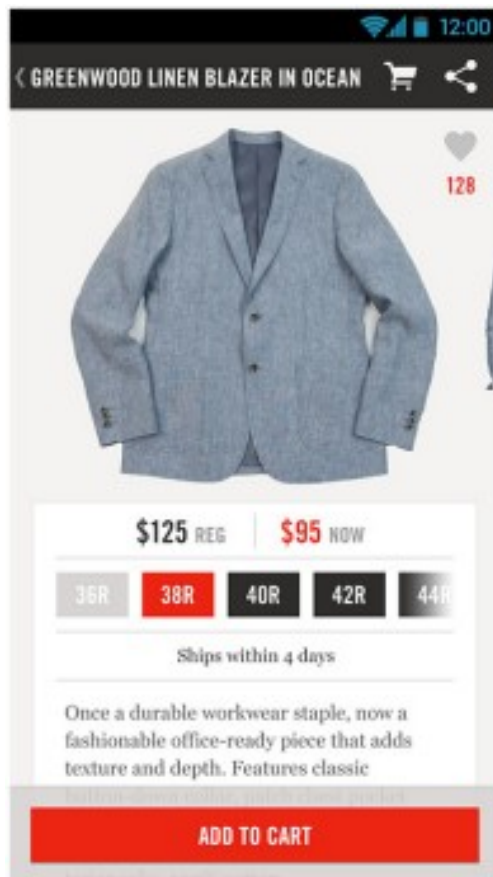
Bottom sheets (for actions)

- Bottom sheets can display actions anchored to the bottom of the screen that are revealed with a slide-up gesture on the visible handle

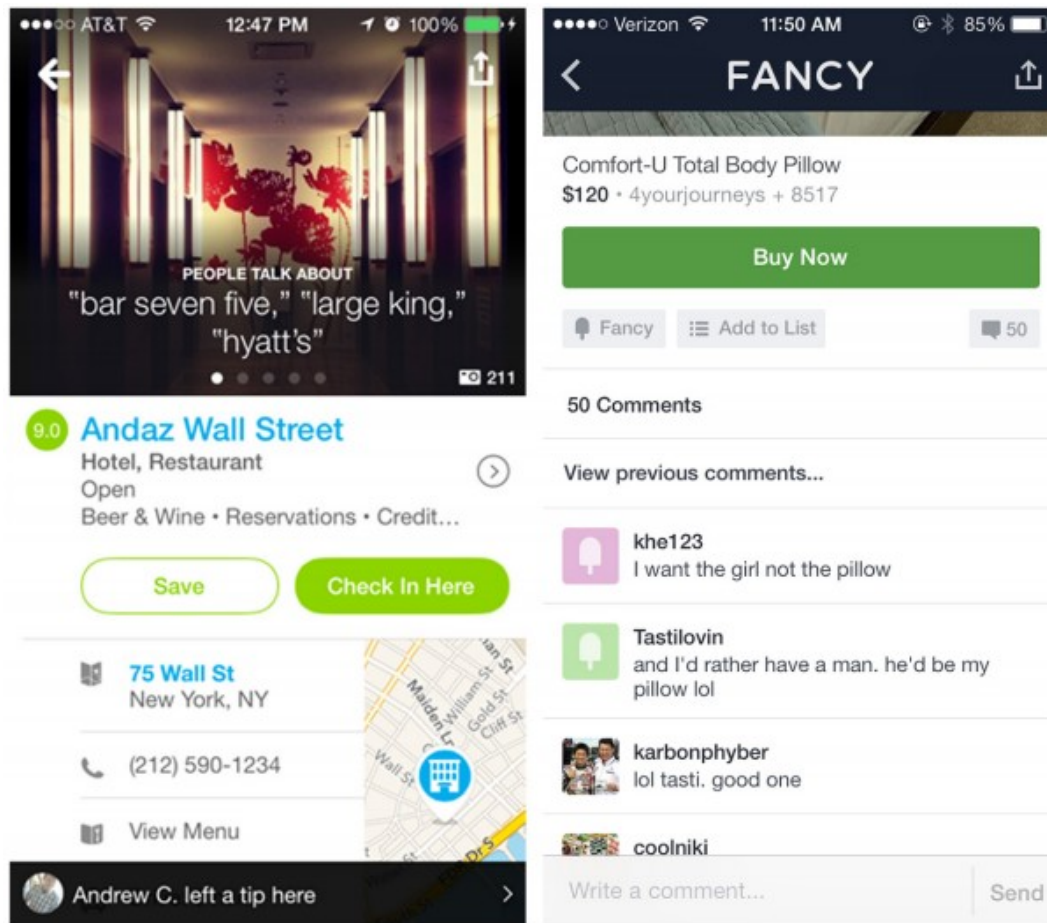


Call to Action button

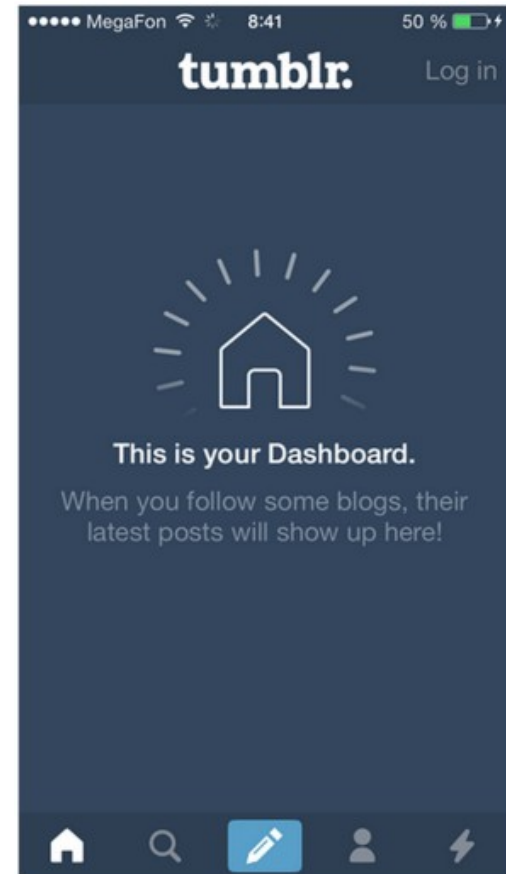
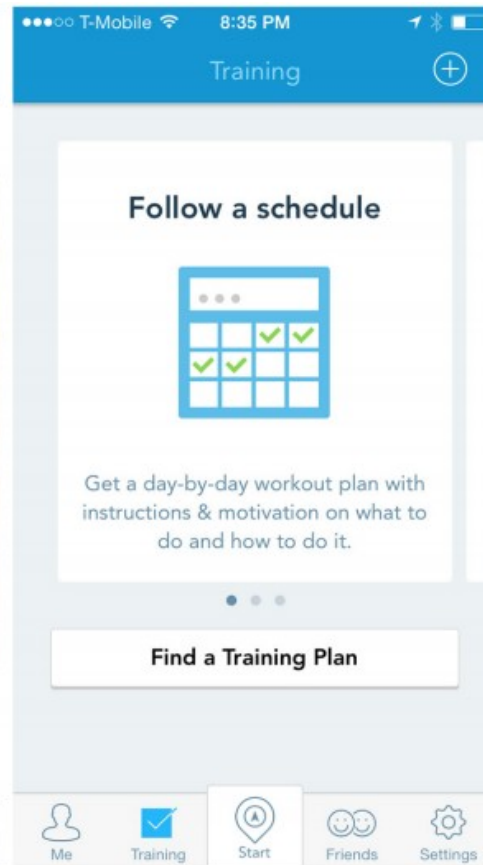
- A Call to Action (CTA) button is the best option when you are presenting one single (important) action on the screen



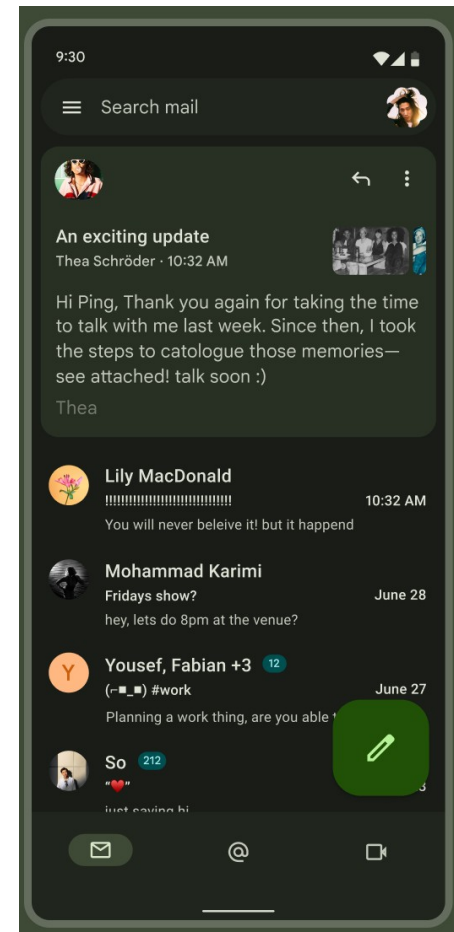
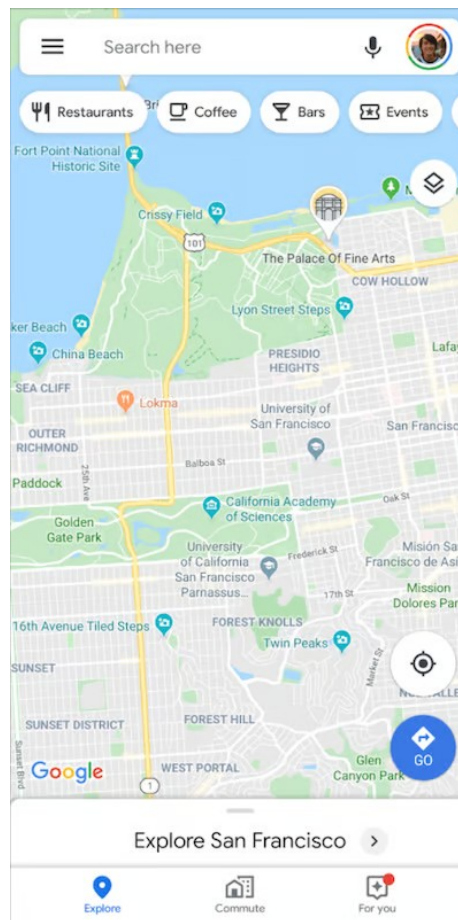
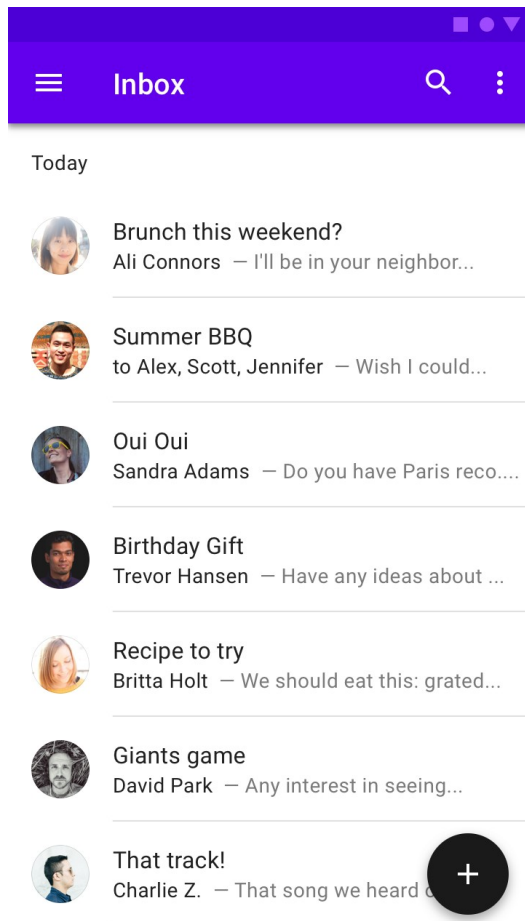
- This pattern may also work for screens with one primary and one (or a couple) ancillary CTAs



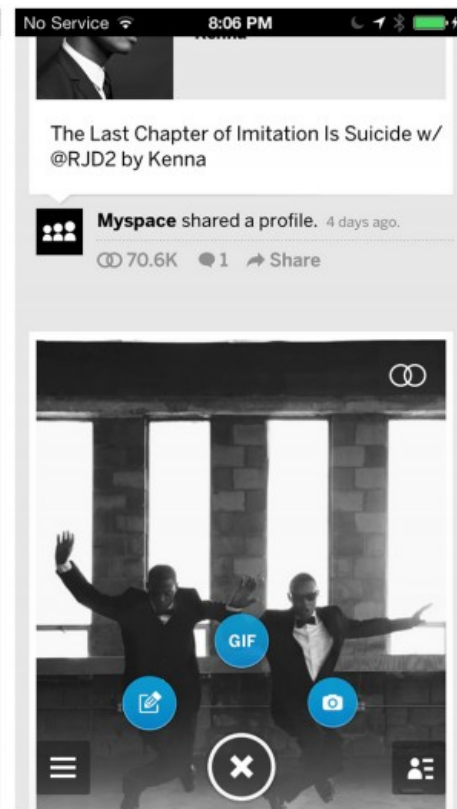
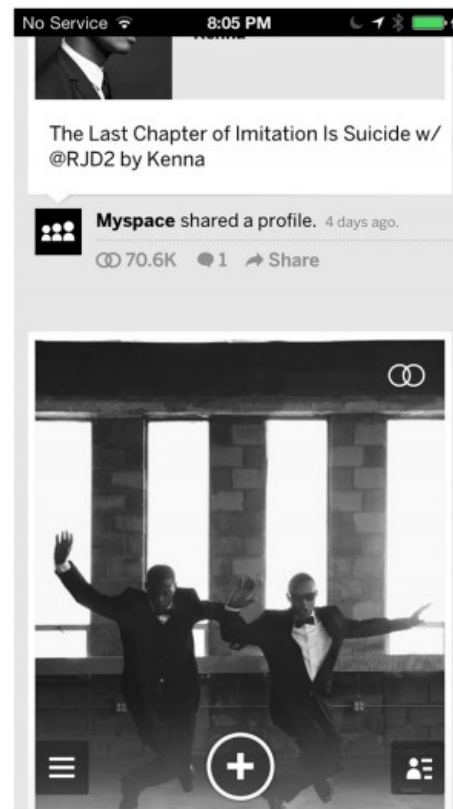
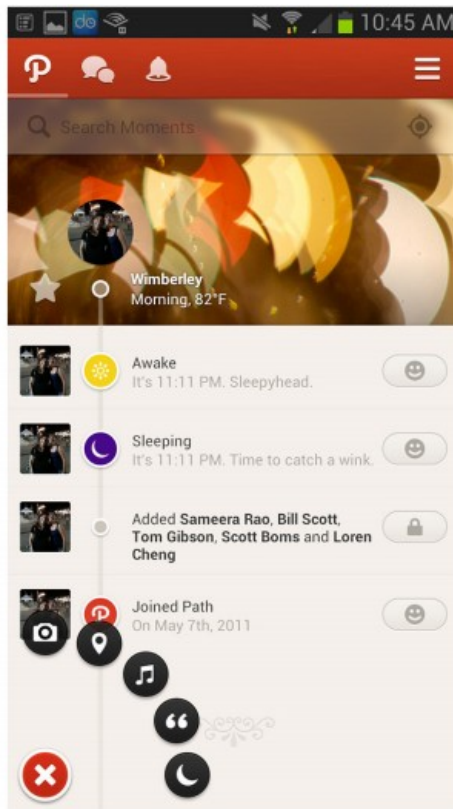
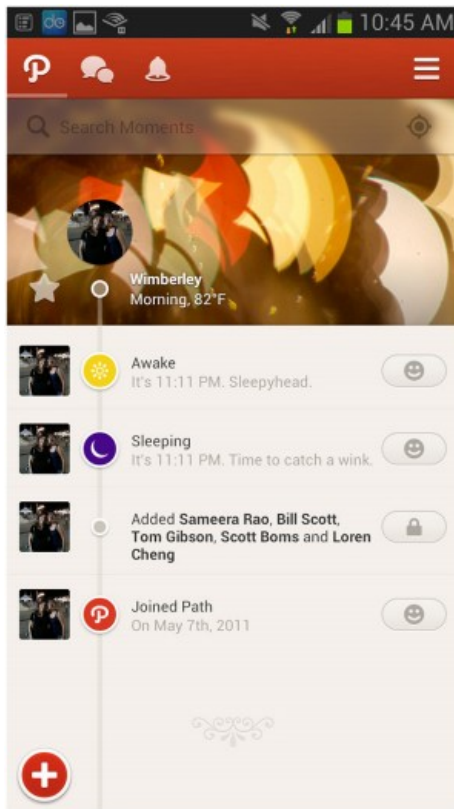
- The Bottom Bar might contain a CTA button to make the related action always accessible in the app



- One CTA design option is a floating CTA button positioned at the bottom of the screen

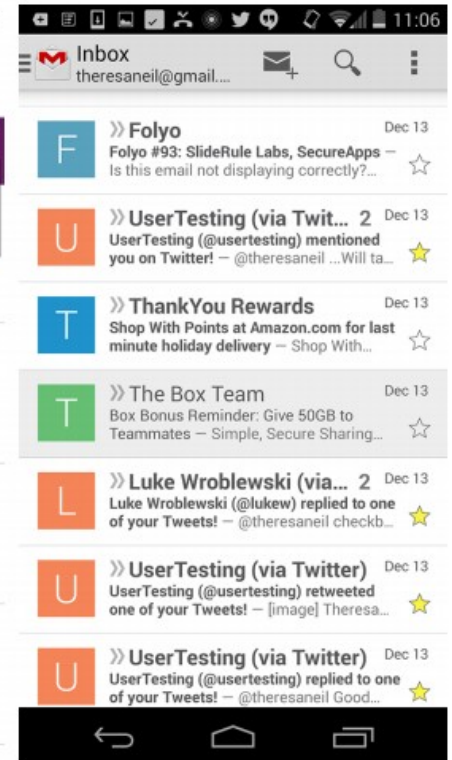
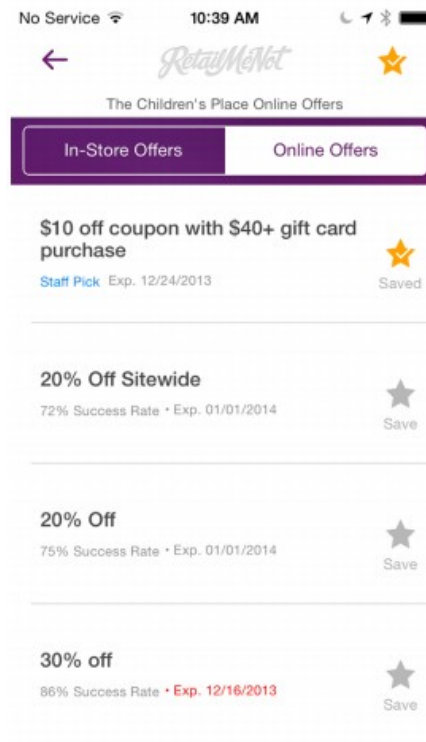
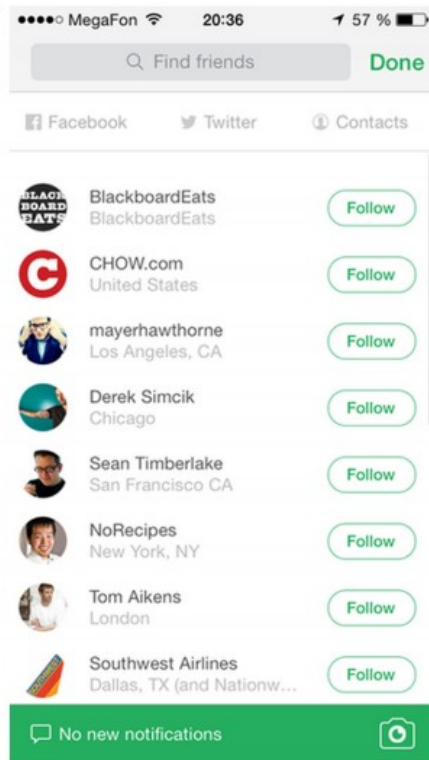
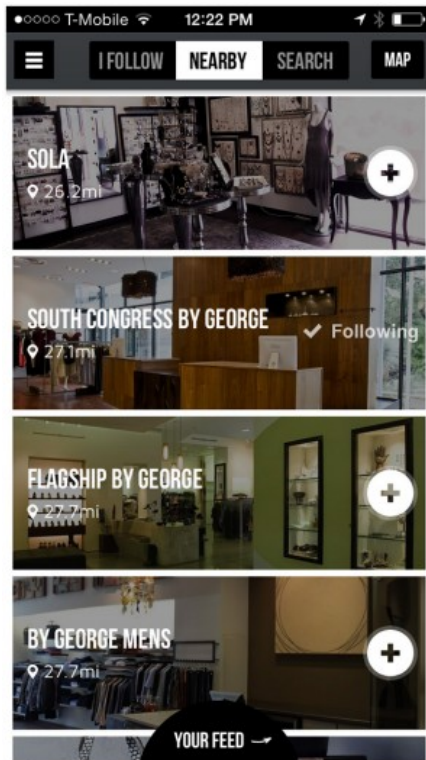


- Some apps reveal additional options when the floating CTA button is tapped

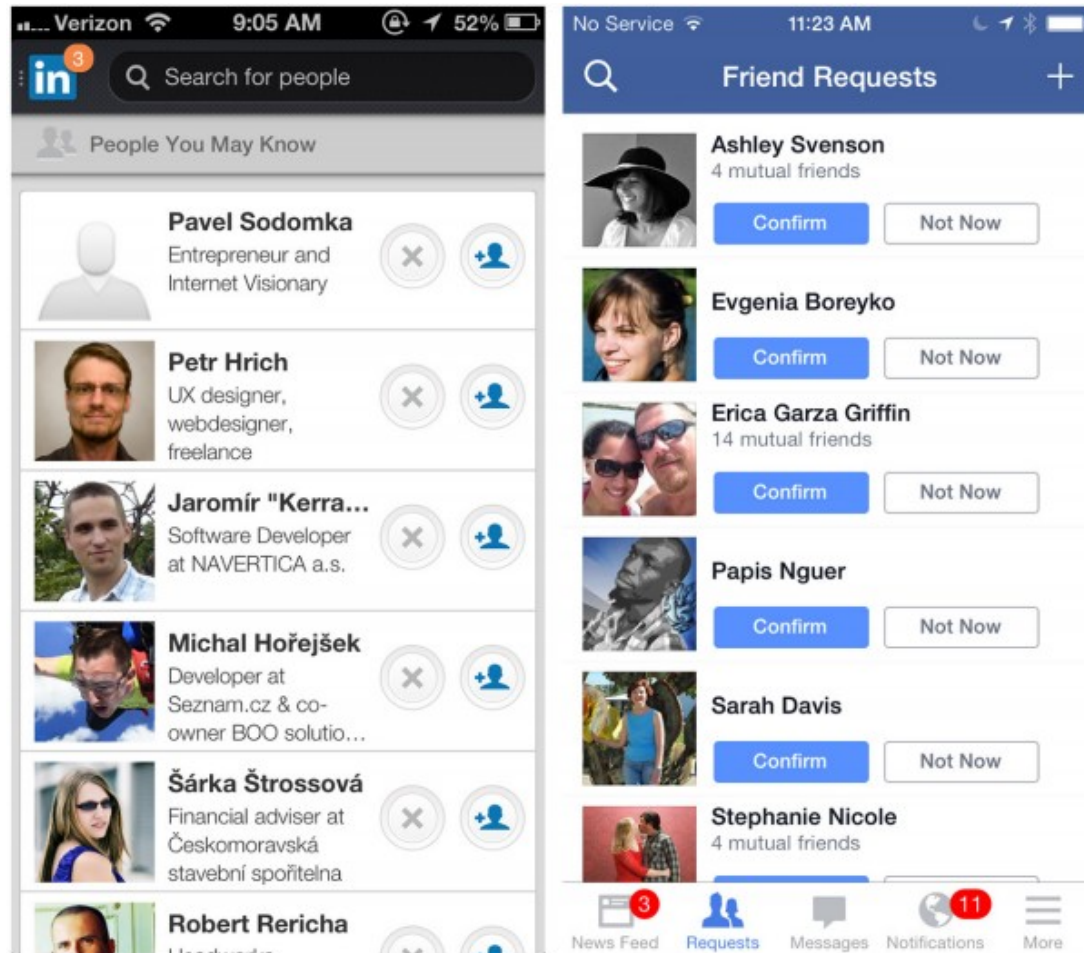


Inline Actions

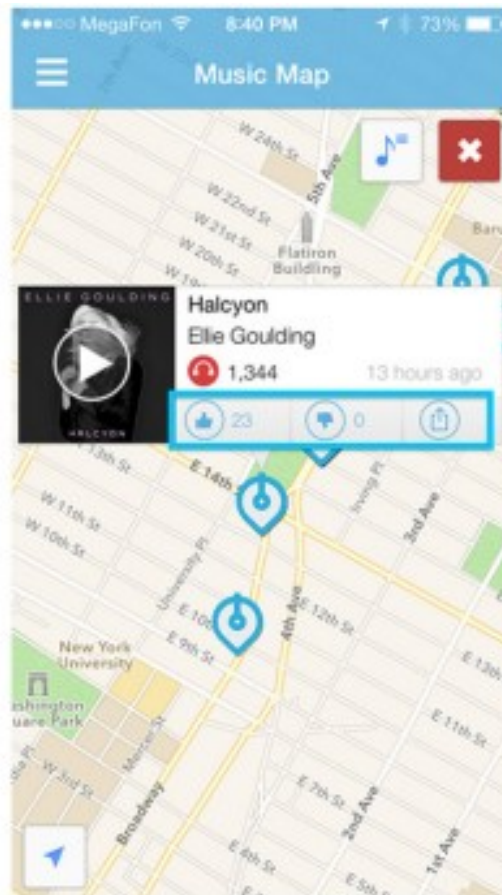
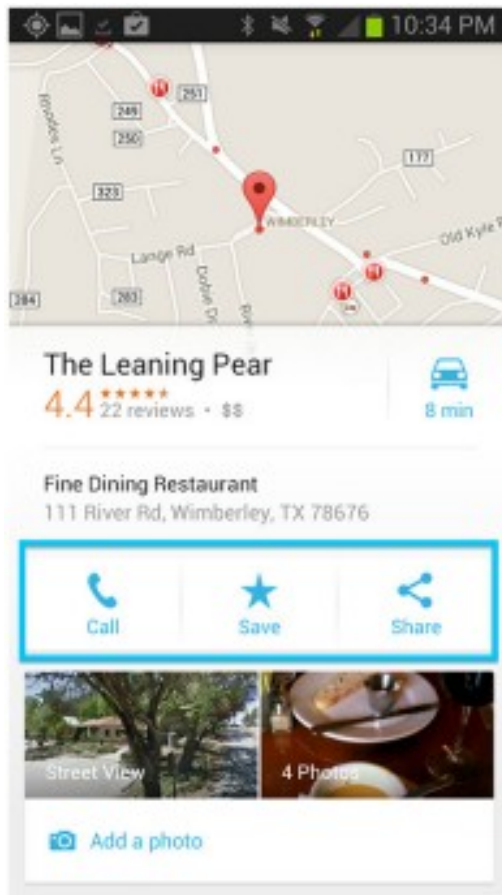
- Inline Actions refer to action buttons that are inline with the object they affect, as opposed to being at a global or screen level



- Inline Actions can be used to show up to two actions per row



- Some apps provide Inline Actions at the object detail view



- Inline actions can reveal in-context inputs to provide a way for people to quickly contribute or create without a lot of effort

James Wang

18 votes by David Cole, Joe Gebbia, Toni Wagner, (more)



“White space is to be regarded as an active element, not a passive background.”

- Jan Tschichold

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Luke Wroblewski, Author of 2 books on Web design, spea... [Edit](#)



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9 votes by Andrew de Andrade, Justin Maxwell, David Cole, (more)

I have many design quotes compiled here:
[http://www.lukew.com/resources/q...](http://www.lukew.com/resources/quotes/q...)

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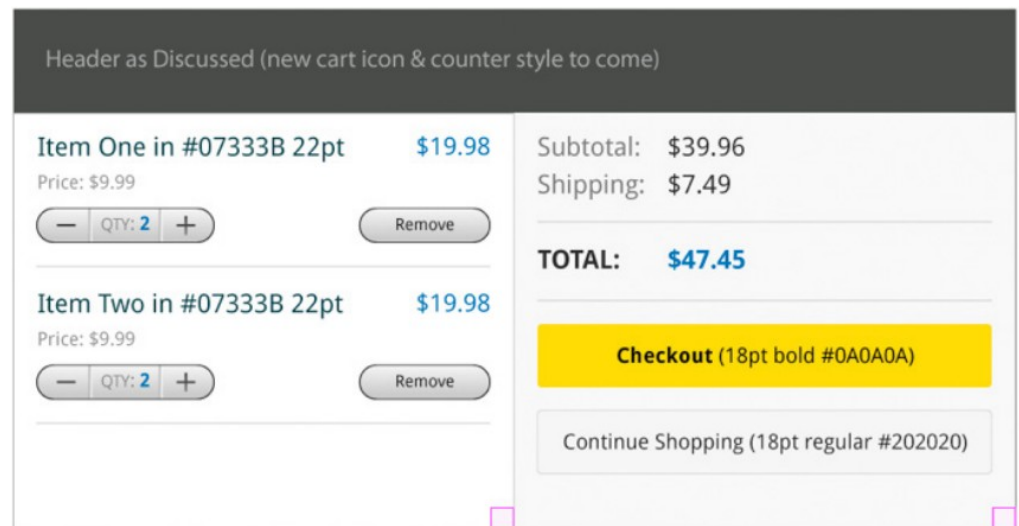
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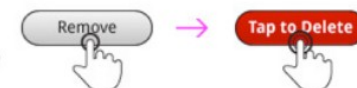
Some of my favorites:

Multi-State Button

- The Multi-State Button is an exception to the rule that you should not assign multiple actions to a UI control
- This type of button acts as both an action trigger and a feedback mechanism
- Multi-State Buttons work well for a series of tightly correlated processes that will be performed in rapid succession
- Also consider using them instead of a dialog to prompt for confirmation before an irreparable action

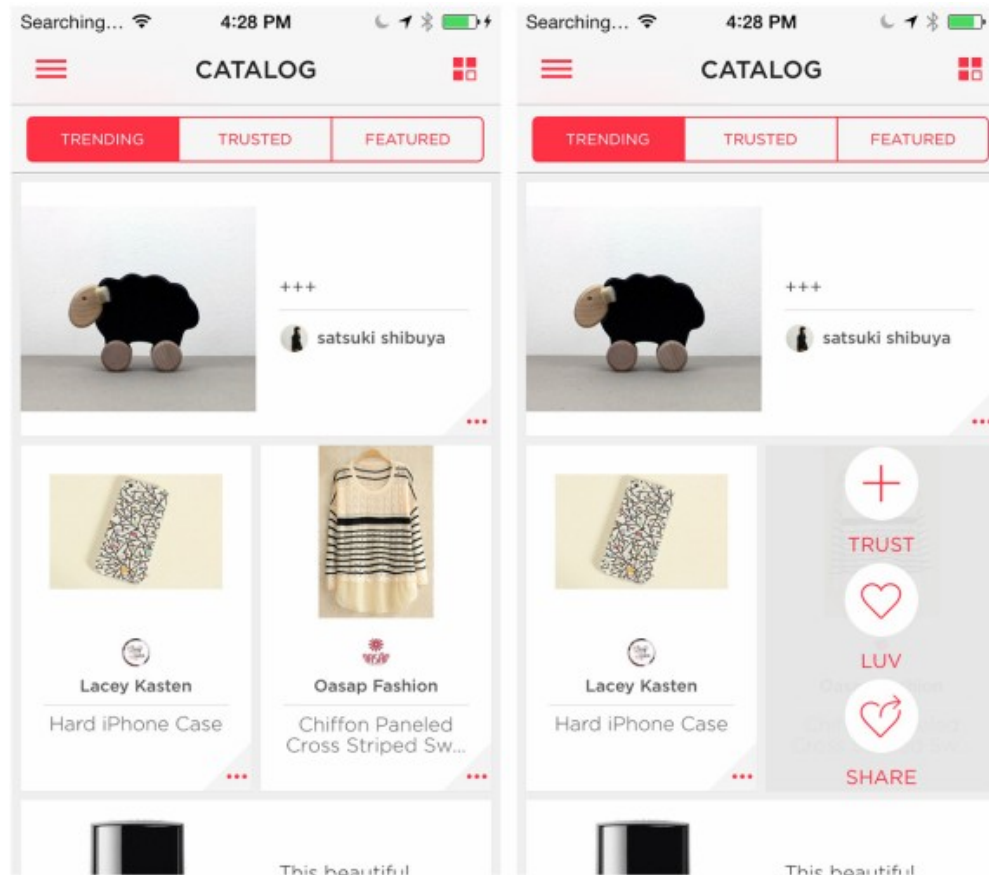


Two-tap Remove: First tap, button changes to red; Second tap commits action (item is removed, others slide up)

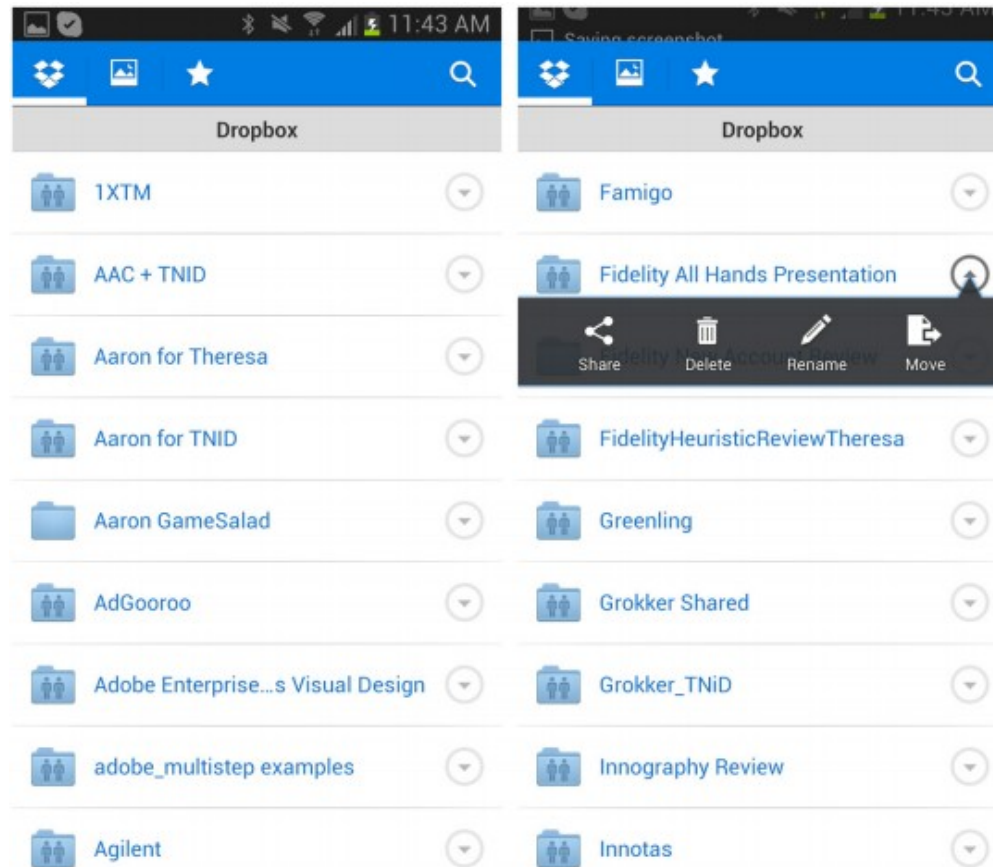


Contextual Tools

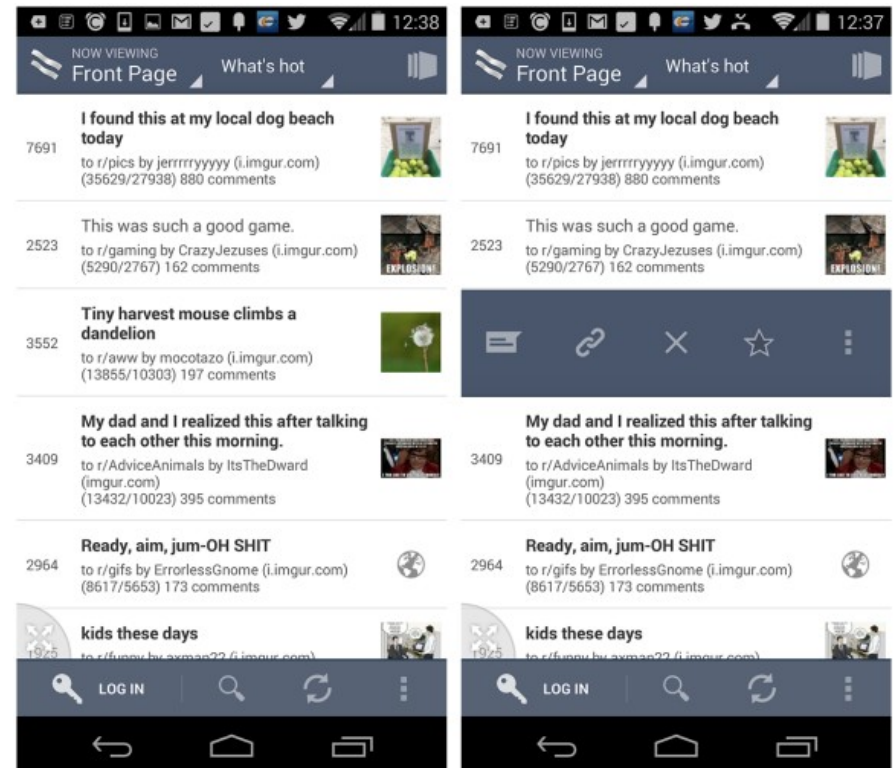
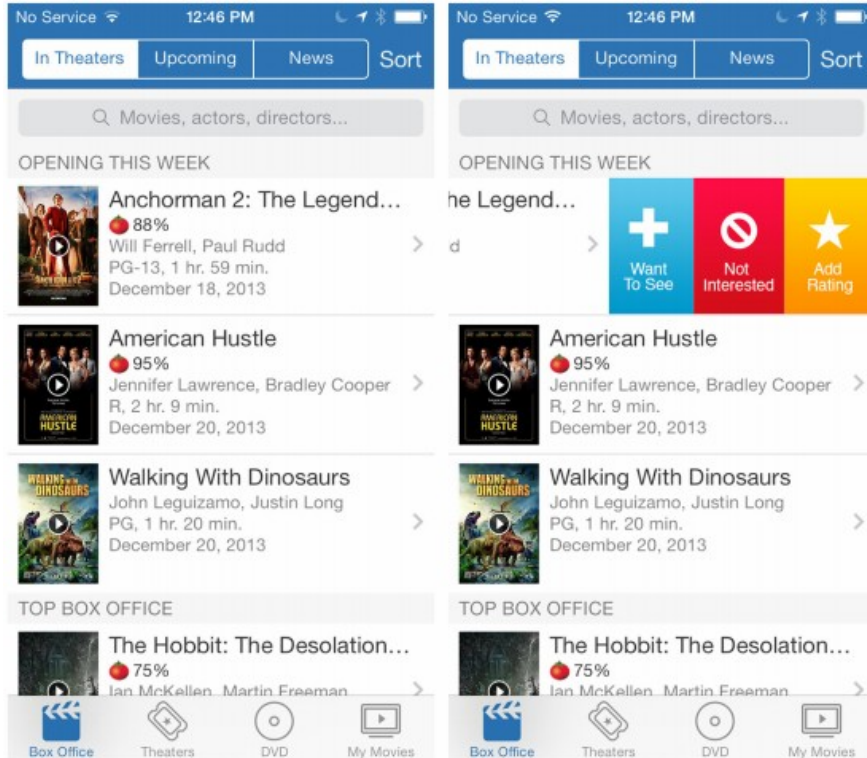
- Contextual Tools are actions specific to an object or task that appear only after the context has been established



- Contextual Tools are typically revealed by tapping on some specific icon



- It is also common to reveal Contextual Tools through gestures such as swiping (in such case, test discoverability and user efficiency)



Bulk Actions

- Apps supporting actions on multiple items (such as delete, select, etc.) should provide a specific mode for these actions

